A THING OF BEAUTY

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

THE CENTRAL THEME AND OVERALL ANALYSIS

This poem is the source of one of the most famous lines in English Literature, that is, "***a thing of beauty is a joy for ever***". This sentence means that the beauty of the world is everlasting, and beauty does not change as the seasons change, or as humans evolve. Something beautiful will always be beautiful, and it will invoke joy in the hearts of all who behold it. These things only grow in beauty and become more and more lovely as time passes. The beauty of the world, of nature, will never dissipate and will bring about a feeling of peace, or calm.

This poem mainly focuses on motivating the reader and filling them with the hope of living their lives happily. It delivers the message about the presence of the things of beauty in this world. These things of beauty should be seen as a source to feel hopeful and do not hesitate in the sad or gloomy times. Also, this poem has the main motive to provide peace to the readers by referring to the beauty of this nature. Here, the poet also connected the natural resources like sun, moon, rivers, etc as the beauty of nature and stated that they can be seen as a support during the gloomy days of this life.

Summary:

According to the poet, John Keats, a thing of beauty is a source of constant joy. Its beauty goes on increasing. It never fades away i.e. it never passes into nothingness. A beautiful thing is as comforting as a bower which is a peaceful and pleasant place in the shade of a tree, providing shelter and protection from the hot rays of the sun, giving us sound sleep, full of pleasant dreams, health and peaceful breathing.

We all possess negative attributes of hatred and disappointment. We suffer from a lack of noble qualities and follow unhealthy, evil ways. In spite of all this a beautiful thing helps us to remove the cover of gloom or darkness from our lives. It makes us love life despite the things that make us sad and dampen our spirits. The trees sprout and spread their branches to provide shelter within their green covering for the simple sheep. Similarly, the sight of daffodils blooming within their green surroundings, the clear and small streams of water which make a cooling shelter for themselves against the hot season, the thick mass of ferns looking grand with their beautiful musk roses are all things of beauty that makes us feel happy.

A beautiful thing is also a source of joy just as the lovely tales we have heard or read give us profound happiness. It is like a fountain of immortality gushing out from nature's endless fountain pours its sacred and immortal drink into the heart and soul of man and is a source of immense joy for us.

‘THINGS OF BEAUTIES IN NATURE’:EFFECTS ON MIND AND BODY

THINGS OF BEAUTIES IN NATURE:The poet mentions various things of beauties in nature which includes a bower,the sun,moon,trees old and young,clear rills,fair musk rose blooms etc.

Keats mentions nature and its parts as things of beaties in his poem a thing of beauty and how all of this bring immense pleasure and joy to human beings getting rid of our despondence and gloomy days compelling us to live on earth another day.

There are various new age evidences to prove how nature affects our physical and mental well being proving keats right.we all have personal experiences of finding solace in mother nature’s lap!

Spending time in nature has been found to help with mental health problems such as anxiety and depression. For example, research into ecotherapy (a type of formal treatment which involves doing activities outside in nature) has shown it can help with mild to moderate depression. This might be due to combining regular physical activity and social contact with being outside in nature.

Being in nature, or even viewing scenes of nature, reduces anger, fear, and stress and increases pleasant feelings. Exposure to nature not only makes you feel better emotionally, it contributes to your physical wellbeing, reducing blood pressure, heart rate, muscle tension, and the production of stress hormones. It may even reduce mortality, according to scientists.

HOW NATURE BENEFITS OUR MENTAL HEALTH?

Spending time in green space or bringing nature into your everyday life can benefit both your mental and physical wellbeing. For example, doing things like growing food or flowers, exercising outdoors or being around animals can have lots of positive effects.

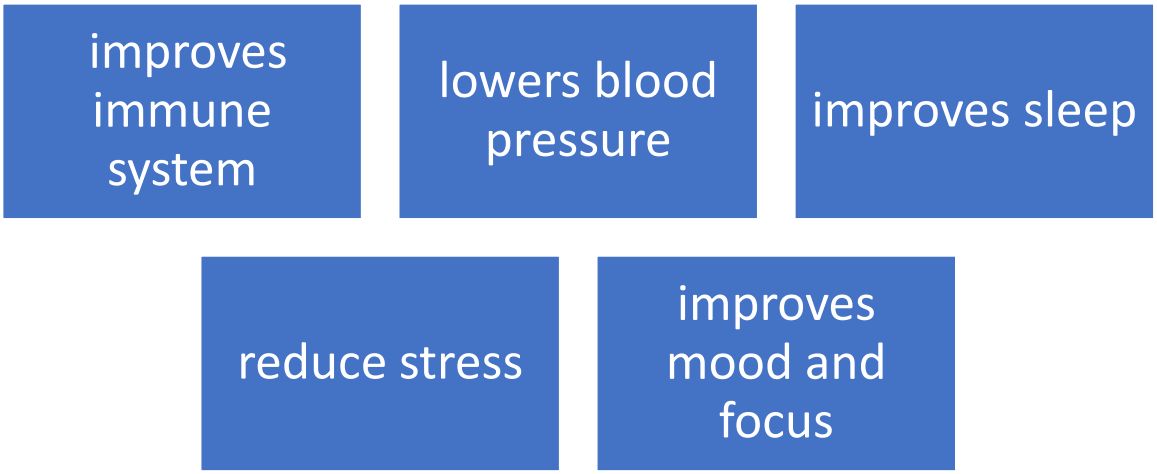
In addition, nature helps us cope with pain. Because we are genetically programmed to find trees, plants, water, and other nature elements engrossing, we are absorbed by nature scenes and distracted from our pain and discomfort.

One of the most intriguing areas of current research is the impact of nature on general wellbeing. In one study in Mind, 95% of those interviewed said their mood improved after spending time outside, changing from depressed, stressed, and anxious to more calm and balanced. Other studies show that time in nature or scenes of nature are associated with a positive mood, and psychological wellbeing, meaningfulness, and vitality.

Furthermore, time in nature or viewing nature scenes increases our ability to pay attention. Because humans find nature inherently interesting, we can naturally focus on what we are experiencing out in nature. This also provides a respite for our overactive minds, refreshing us for new tasks.

Time spent in nature connects us to each other and the larger world. “Nature deprivation,” a lack of time in the natural world, largely due to hours spent in front of TV .

EFFECTS OF SPENDING TIME WITH NATURE ON PHYSICAL AND MENTAL WELLBEING





nature is a friend that we can confide in,a soft breeze can make our day better

a walk in nature can make us care for it and conserve it which will preserve our ecosystem

often people go on solo trips to be with nature to escape busy and stressful life

Nature: How connecting with nature benefits our mental health

Nature is an important need for many and vital in keeping us emotionally, psychologically and physically healthy.

When it comes to mental health benefits, nature has a very wide definition. It can mean green spaces such as parks, woodland or forests as well as blue spaces like rivers, wetlands, beaches or canals. It also includes trees on an urban street, private gardens, verges and even indoor plants or window boxes. Surprisingly, even watching nature documentaries has been shown to be good for our mental health. This is great news as it means the mental health benefits of nature can be made available to nearly every one of us, no matter where we live.

Spending time in nature is good for us for lots of reasons. “Fresh air and exercise” has long been recommended as a way for many to feel better, physically and mentally. Now evidence shows us that the quality of our relationship with nature is part of the reason for its positive impact on our wellbeing. Researchers use the term “connectedness” to describe the ideal relationship.

Connectedness refers to the way we relate to nature and experience nature. A strong connection with nature means feeling a close relationship or an emotional attachment to our natural surroundings.

we might notice the beauty of nature by listening intently to birdsong or touching the bark of trees. Smelling flowers or feeling the soil between our fingers

People with good nature connectedness tend to be happier

research shows that people who are more connected with nature are usually happier in life and more likely to report feeling their lives are worthwhile. Nature can generate a multitude of positive emotions, such as calmness, joy, creativity and can facilitate concentration.

Nature connectedness is also associated with lower levels of poor mental health; in particular lower depression and anxiety levels.

Perhaps not surprisingly, people with strong nature connectedness are also more likely to have pro-environmental behaviours such as recycling items or buying seasonal food. This is likely to lead to further benefits, if these pro-environmental activities can lead to improvements in nature that we can then go on to enjoy. At a time of devastating environmental threats, developing a stronger mutually supportive relationship between people and the environment will be critical.

high quality" natural spaces are better for us and our wellbeing.

Quality can mean higher biodiversity (a wide variety of plants and wildlife). Whether we are in rural or urban spaces, certain characteristics of nature are particularly important. These include the amount of "green" in trees, plants, and grass, the variety of plants and wildlife, and "serene" landscapes that feel calm and quiet.

Cleanliness in natural spaces also affects our mental and physical health.

ECOTHERAPY: NATURE IN TREATMENT

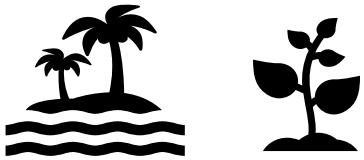
Nature therapy, also called ecotherapy, is the practice of being in nature to boost growth and healing, especially mental health. You might also hear it called green care, green exercise, green therapy, or horticulture therapy. Although people use those terms to describe lots of outdoor activities, they can also be examples of specific nature therapy programs.

Being in a green space has been linked to less anxiety, fewer depression symptoms, and lower stress levels. Spending time in nature helps people with depression.

Nature therapy might involve places like gardens, farms, forests, or parks. Usually, nature therapy involves experiencing nature (like taking a walk through the forest) or working in nature (like gardening) and kids with attention problems think more clearly.

Nature therapy includes adventures,conservation,nature walks,green exercise and therapeutic farming.





QUESTIONNAIRE AND PERSONAL EXPERIENCES

1) HOW HAS NATURE HELPED YOU DEAL WITH STRESS?

NATURE HELPED ME TO DEAL WITH STRESS BY SHOWING ME GOD IS IN CONTROL . TO HEAR AND SEE THE OCEAN MOVE WITH THE WIND , AND TREES DANCE WITH POISE AND EASE BLOWING WERE THE SUMMER AIR GUIDES THEM BRINGS ME TO A PLACE OF CALMNESS AND PEACE. NATURE HAS BEEN A BLESSING THAT HAS ALWAYS BEEN WITH ME DESPITE ALL HARDSHIPS WHEN ALL MY RELATIONS FAILED ME , I FOUND SOLACE IN MOTHER NATURE'S LAP.- MEENA (VICTIM OF DOMESTIC ABUSE)

I THINK THE IRREGULAR SHAPES, SPIRALS AND VARIETY OF COLOURS HAS A SUBCONSCIOUS IMPACT TO... AND JUST THE FACT YOU'RE NOT IN YOUR REGULAR ENVIRONMENT, MEANING THAT YOU DON'T RECEIVE REGULAR SENSE IMPRESSIONS.BUT IT DEFINITELY DOES WORK FOR ME, ENHANCES ANY MEDITATION PRACTICE TO EVEN JUST BE IN NATURE, THE WILDER THE BETTER...

-RAM(YOGA AND NATURE ENTHUSIAST)

2)HOW LONG HAVE YOU BEEN USING NATURE TO COPE WITH STRESS AND KEEP YOURSELF REJUVENATED.

I AM 60 AND FOR MOST OF MY LIFE I'VE SPENT TIME ENJOYING NATURE. AS A CHILD I SPENT ENDLESS HOURS PLAYING IN A CREEK AND EXPLORING THE WOODS ON MY GRANDFATHER'S FARM. I WENT TO A BOARDING SCHOOL IN OOTY. AFTER CLASSES WERE OVER I WOULD GO HIKING AROUND THE TRAILS. AS AN ADULT I STARTED HIKING EVERY WEEKEND . ALL THE STRESS FROM THE WORK WEEK WOULD JUST MELT AWAY. I GO UP THERE AS OFTEN AS POSSIBLE. I BATTLE DEPRESSION, ANXIETY AND PTSD AND HAVE FOUND THAT SPENDING TIME IN NATURE HELPS ME MORE THAN ANYTHING. I WALK A COUPLE OF MILES IN A LOVELY WOODED PARK EVERY MORNING TO CLEAR MY HEAD AND REDUCE STRESS.

-MAHADEVAN

I'VE BEEN DOING THIS INTENTIONALLY FOR A FEW MONTHS (ALTHOUGH MY WHOLE LIFE I WOULD BE IN NATURE BECAUSE IT FELT GOOD). I GO TO A CONSERVATION AREA WHERE THERE IS NO ONE. THEN I MEDITATE. I GO TO THE PARK. JUST LOOK AT WHAT IS RIGHT IN FRONT OF ME. REALLY TAKE IT IN. THE COLOR, THE SHAPE, THE SMELLS, THE SOUNDS. BUT JUST WHAT IS LITERALLY RIGHT IN FRONT OF ME. NOT WHAT IS OFF OUT TO THE SIDE A WAYS OR OUT IN FRONT A WAYS. I LOOK UP TO THE SKY. I TAKE IT ALL IT. I THINK ABOUT WHAT IS RIGHT IN FRONT OF ME. AND THEN THE STRESS GETS LESSENED. OKAY, I JUST CONVINCED MYSELF TO GO TO THE WOODS. -SANDRA(NATURE AND PSYCOLOGY ENTHUSIAST)

3)HOW DOES HOME PLANTING RELIEVE STRESS?

BEING IN THE NATURE WITH PLANTS, TREES, ANIMALS AND SOIL IS A METHOD OF GROUNDING ONESELF (BEING IN THE PRESENT) USING THE 5 SENSES. IT IS ALSO A WAY OF EXERCISING AND A DISTRACTION FROM STRESS. IT CAN BE A SATISFYING HOBBY FROM WHICH MUCH CAN BE LEARNED, CREATED AND SHARED AND BEAUTY APPRECIATED.

4)HOW OFTEN DO YOU GO ON SOLO TRIPS AND WHAT IMPACT HAS IT HAD ON YOUR MENTAL HEALTH?

EVERY NOW AND THEN WHEN I FEEL MENTALLY STRAINED I GO ON SOLO TRIP TO MY NATIVE PLACE COONOOR,I FEEL RELAXED AND AT HOME ,ALL MY STRESS COMES TO A TEMPORARY HALT .ALL THE SCENIC BEAUTIES AND CLEAR WATER STREAMS MELTS MY HEART .IT FEELS LIKE A PARADISE TO BE WITH NATURE.

-SUMITHRA(AN IT PROFESSIONAL)

5)AS A TEENAGER HOW HAVE YOU FOUND SOLACE IN NATURE?

NATURE HAS BEEN A CONFIDANTE TO ME AS I AM INTROVERTED,ALL MY SUNDAYS ARE SPENT WITH NATURE,HIKING ,TREKKING OR A SIMPLE WALK IN THE PARK ,WATERING AND TALKING WITH MY PLANTS IN THE GARDEN,INHALING THE FRESH BREEZE.ESPECIALLY DURING THE COVID 19 PANDEMIC NATURE HAS BEEN MY ONLY RESOLVE. -NIRRAIMOZHI(15 YEAR OLD)